8.2 DBM-STYLE DATABASE ABSTRACTION

The DBA functions abstract communications with databases that conform to the style of Berkeley DB database systems. Rather than storing complex records, a DBM database simply stores key/value pairs. This is similar to an associative array.

The functions replace a set of functions that allow just one type of DBM database. These new functions allow for choosing the underlying system from within your PHP code rather than compiling PHP for a single DBM implementation. You choose a type of database when you open a connection, and the rest of the functions perform accordingly. Sascha Schumann added these functions to PHP.

Keyword

Database connection is a facility in computer science that allows client software to talk to database server software, whether on the same machine or not.

dba_close(integer link)

The dba_close function closes a link to a database. The link argument is an integer returned by the dba_open or dba_popen functions. If you choose not to close a **database connection**, PHP will close it for you.

boolean dba_delete(string key, integer link)

The dba_delete function removes an entry from a database. You must supply both the key and a valid link to a database, as supplied by dba_open or dba_popen. The success of the delete is returned as a boolean.

```
<?
  // open database in write mode
  $db = dba_popen('inventory', 'w', 'gdbm');

  if($db)
  {
    //check for record
```